By now, Isha was in the eleventh grade and had taken humanities as her stream. Mhow had an Army Public School, but unfortunately, it only offered the science and commerce streams. To pursue humanities, Isha would have to go to some school in Indore, entailing a commute of an hour or so each way. We were in a quandary as to what to do. Isha was not too keen to move out of Delhi either. She had made a place for herself at school and was even on the editorial board of the school magazine, *Aviral*. I went to the MS Branch to inquire whether it was possible to get a posting to Delhi on termination of the HC 32 course, in April 2004. After reviewing my profile, the extensive periods spent in field areas, particularly the CO's tenure, and the fact that I had never been posted to Delhi earlier, the MS Branch was pretty sure of being able to accommodate me in Delhi. Accordingly, we decided that I would go alone to Mhow, another ten months of separation, for the sake of the continuity of the children's education.

The ten months of the HC course passed off in a blur. This was the third course I was attending at the AWC, after JC and SC, and all three times, I had to come alone for some reason or the other. The best part of the HC course is the extensive travelling to all parts of India (foreign tours started from HC 33 onwards). We would visit each of the Corps of the Army, getting the operational briefings before moving down to Divisions and Brigades to get the actual feel of the ground. It is impossible for everyone to have served everywhere, so this familiarization was extremely illuminating. Tours to civilian and industrial establishments were also conducted, which broadened our horizons immensely. I was very impressed and captivated by the visits to the Bombay Stock Exchange and the Reliance offices at the Dhirubhai Ambani Knowledge City. Reliance was then laying miles and miles of optical fibre cables (OFC) and we

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